

Kathmandu Valley HRRP coordination meeting

Date: 18 01 2017

Time: 2:00 PM

Location: HRRP Meeting Hall, Jwagal Lalitpur

Participant Organizations: HRRP, British Red Cross, Habitat for Humanity, Lumanti, OXFAM, UNOPS, NSET, Freelancers, MIT.

Agendas

1. Introduction
2. Retrofitting
3. Training
4. Technical assistance
5. WASH
6. Community infrastructure
7. NRA contacts
8. Next steps
9. AoB

1. Introduction

- The meeting was facilitated by Kathmandu valley HRRP coordinator Mr. Rupak Risal. Representatives from seven PO, researchers and freelancers attended the meeting.
- Themes for discussion in the meeting were issues and challenges on retrofitting of damaged buildings, new ToR and guidelines on retrofitting, short training coverage areas and gaps, technical assistance package with six activities, their coverage areas and gaps, sectorial updates on WASH, Education and Health, and enrollment updates in the valley.

2. Retrofitting

- GoN has recently developed guidelines and technical notes for retrofitting.
- OXFAM has released a new training ToR for retrofitting. The training will start from next week for twenty engineers working in the field for municipalities. Those engineers can further advice and provide orientation to masons working in the field.
- A seismic assessment of a blood bank was done through CoRD in Bhaktapur. It was observed that demand for this activity is huge in the country but resources are very limited.
- NSET are looking to develop a mandatory rule of thumb for retrofitting, already retrofitted close to three hundred buildings in the valley, hence can develop methods for the valley. The grant of NRs. 100,000 would make a lot of sense for rural area buildings.
- Lack of resources for retrofitting job is being witnessed. NRA claims it doesn't have sufficient fund for retrofitting hence PO can contribute in this aspect.

3. Training

- There are thirteen municipalities where trainings have been conducted, with nine hundred beneficiaries of seven days' mason training so far. Vocational training or on the job training lasts fifty days.
- It was observed that there was no mechanism of monitoring the whereabouts of trained masons. There's not much information about quality or impact of these trainings. PO were asked to share if they had any data regarding this.
- NSET has additional data regarding number of trained masons in the valley which is to be added in HRRP 4W.
- Most of the masons trained in Kageshwori Manahara municipality are from outside the valley, hence it was hard to track them.
- In Karyabinayak municipality, there's already a system of registration for trained masons to track them.

4. Technical assistance

- Technical assistance orientation is being provided in all households of rural areas where NSET is present, regardless of whether they need reconstruction or repair. In the valley blanket coverage is not possible as it requires huge amount of human resources.
- In urban areas, people are required to submit the architectural drawing of what they want to construct or reconstruct in their municipalities and then they are registered for the orientation. NSET provides technical assistance orientation to those household owners in their respective municipalities every Friday.
- Three social mobilizers and two engineers are in a team to provide door to door technical assistance in all municipalities and VDCs. This program is being implemented via NSET with USAID's assistance.
- Gap in technical assistance is being witnessed in the valley (Kindly see the 'Map: Coverage of 6 TA activities', PPP slide #6 in another attachment).

5. WASH

- Partner organizations were requested to share toilet designs and WASH information materials to support with defining the criteria for households to receive NRs. 25000 of the last tranche of the housing grant.
- There were no updates about WASH activity in the valley after HRRP 4W was revised.
- An NGO has taken initiative for construction of one hundred and nineteen latrines in Karyabinayak municipality albeit without any permission from the authority.

6. Community infrastructure

- 86 educational institutions in Kathmandu district required reconstruction and 192 needed repair. 56 schools are being reconstructed and 10 being repaired, leaving the gap of 30 in reconstruction and 182 in repair.
- In Lalitpur district, two school buildings in Karyabinayak municipality are under reconstruction.
- No records of Bhaktapur district yet.
- There are fifty Rotary clubs in the valley who are reportedly doing a lot of activities on community infrastructure reconstruction. Twelve schools in Patan area, rehabilitation of a pond in Bungamati are the ongoing activities by several Rotary clubs in Kathmandu valley. Rotary also has MoU with NRA for one hundred and forty school buildings reconstruction and one thousand

low cost shelters (NRs. 300,000 each). Rotary is also spending NRs. Four hundred and fifty thousand without any objection from NRA.

- Details of all Rotary activities can be provided by ERRP of Rotary Club. There could be some Rotary clubs who are doing reconstruction activities without informing ERRP.
- Red Cross has plans for reconstruction of three health posts in the valley

7. NRA contacts

- Contacts of office heads of respective districts were shared with attendees. It was followed by enrollment update from all districts in the valley.
- In Bhaktapur, with 26016 eligible beneficiaries, no one has received the first tranche yet.
- In Kathmandu, with 42655 eligible beneficiaries, 17050 beneficiaries have received the first tranche yet.
- In Lalitpur district out of 25892 eligible beneficiaries, 2036 have received the first tranche yet. No one in the valley have received the second tranche as of today.

8. Next step

The next HRRP coordination meeting will be held in district NRA offices of Kathmandu valley simultaneously. Details about date, time and location to will be sent later after confirming with respective offices.

9. AoB

- Reconstruction in the valley is taking place completely through formal process. In rural areas masons are hired on a daily basis, same is the case in urban areas as well though about five percent hire consultants or engineers for construction.
- Commercial buildings are being constructed following the formal process while private housing are through consulting firms or contractors albeit still are owner driven.
- In rural areas hiring masons is responsibility of the owner while in urban areas petty contractors hire masons for construction activities. Mason training is still very important.
- UNOPS is assisting NRA and CBS to conduct the survey in seventeen least affected districts. UNOPS has three hundred and fifty engineers in fifteen districts as of yet. They will have four hundred and seventy engineers across all seventeen districts by the end of next week. Tentatively by mid-March, they expect to finish the survey but can't be guaranteed.
- Any other partner organizations interested to work in those seventeen districts are requested to contact with CBS staffs.

Action Points

1. HRRP will ask the locations of remaining school buildings that need reconstruction or repair with NRA offices of all three districts in the valley to be shared with partner organizations. Same to be done with any other sector related activities in Kathmandu valley and to be shared with partner organizations.
2. HRRP will request all partner organizations to update their activities in our 4W since there hasn't been any coordination team in the valley for a long time.
3. HRRP will take initiative for the arrangement of meetings between partner organizations and respective district level NRA offices in Kathmandu valley.

Meeting Participants List/Attendance Sheet

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